

PORT FOLIO

Fashion & Culture Writer | Editorial Strategy | Interviews & Trend Analysis

Fashion and culture writer with a background in marketing communications and editorial strategy. My work combines cultural insight, storytelling, and trend analysis across fashion, beauty, and contemporary media.

Instagram: @leraytova

LinkedIn: Valerie Aitova

email: leraytova@gmail.com

HELLO, I'M VALERIE AITOVA

Over the past few years, I've written for magazines and media platforms in both the **UK and Russia**, covering fashion, beauty, internet culture, branding, identity, and the aesthetics shaping Gen Z today.

I work across features, interviews, and editorial storytelling, covering fashion, beauty, culture, and digital aesthetics while interviewing designers, founders, and creatives from across the industry.

As a Gen Z writer who is online most of the time, I've always been fascinated by the relationship between fashion and identity, how media, pop culture, and digital spaces shape the way we see ourselves. I grew up watching *The Devil Wears Prada* long before I understood the industry itself. Now, writing about fashion, beauty, and culture feels a little like turning those early obsessions into a career. *(not just for Carrie Bradshaw, but for me too).*

I'm especially interested in contemporary fashion media, luxury branding, beauty culture, internet aesthetics, and the cultural shifts that happen before they become trends.

INTRODUCTION



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EDUCATION

Birkbeck, University of London, UK

MSc Marketing Communications

Focused on branding, consumer behaviour, digital marketing, and contemporary media culture, with a particular interest in fashion and beauty industries.

Kuban State University, Russia

BA Western European Studies

Developed a strong interdisciplinary background across culture, media, history, communications, and contemporary European society, with a focus on art, cultural identity, and visual culture.

COURSES & CERTIFICATIONS

Fashion Journalism Short Course

UAL: University of Arts London, 2026

McKinsey Forward Program

McKinsey & Company, 2026

LVMH INSIDE Certificate

LVMH, 2025

Fundamentals of Digital Marketing

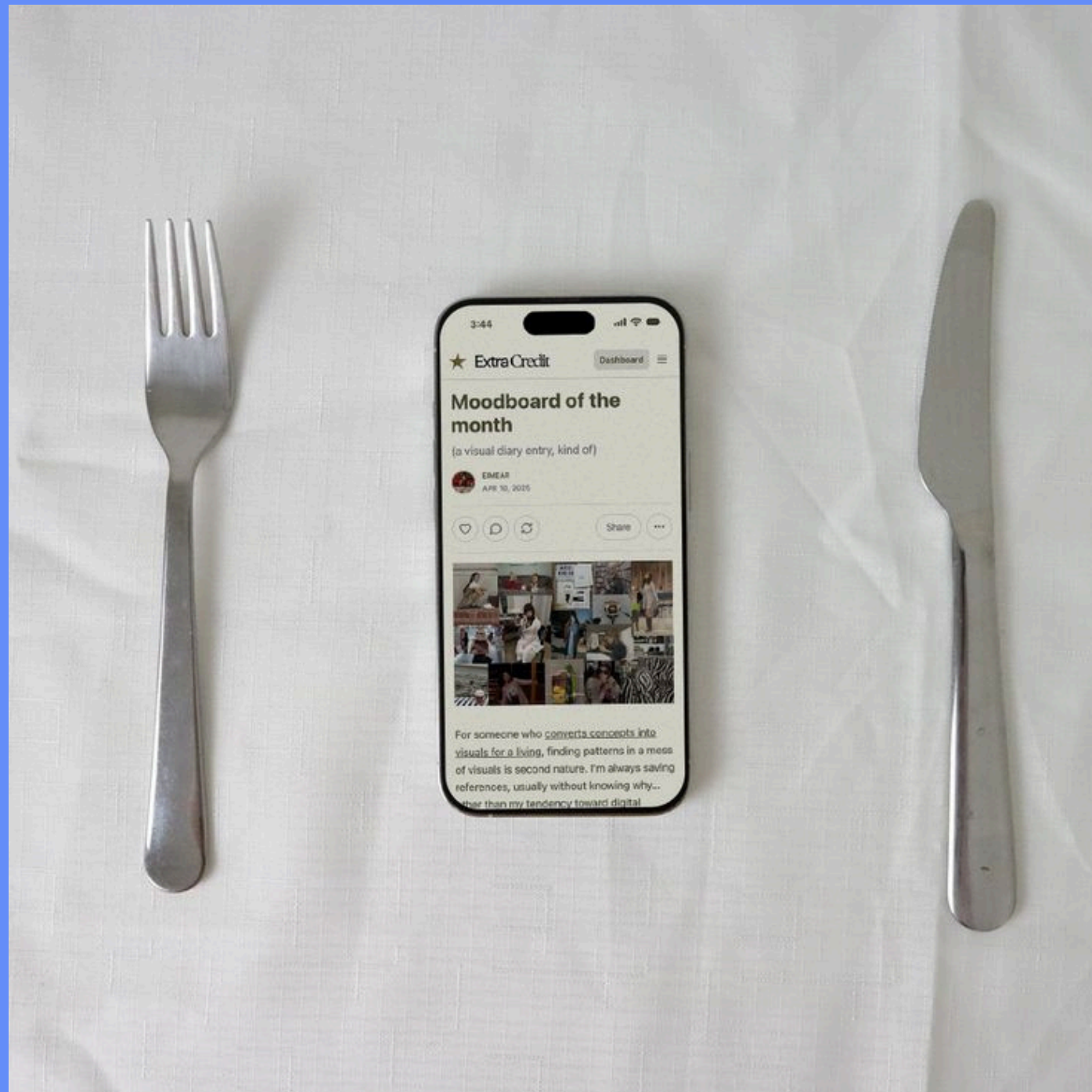
Google, 2025

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PERSONAL SKILLS



Editorial

Editorial Storytelling • Copywriting • Editing •
Interviewing • Narrative Development

Creative

Creative Direction • Photography • Visual
Research • Aesthetic Sensibility

Strategy & Digital

Social Media Management • Content
Strategy • Brand Storytelling • Trend
Forecasting • Audience Insight • Internet
Culture Awareness

Communication

Cross-Cultural Communication •
Community Building • Creative Thinking •
Attention to Detail

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Editorial & Distribution Manager – HYG Magazine

Managing fashion, beauty and culture features from pitch to publication while overseeing contributor communication and editorial direction. I also conduct interviews with creatives and support HYG's editorial distribution across LinkedIn and social platforms.

Social Media Manager & Video Content Assistant – Ivanova Coaching

Created video and social media content tailored to audience behaviour and platform trends. Assisted with content planning, editing and multi-platform growth strategies.

Content & Community Manager – World Without Borders

Developing content strategies and community-focused campaigns across social media platforms. Worked on influencer collaborations, newsletters and audience engagement, using analytics to optimise performance and brand visibility.

Exhibition Intern – Krasnodar Regional Art Museum

Supported exhibition research and cultural projects while analysing museum practices and digital communication strategies. Assisted in organising exhibitions and updating online content for the museum.



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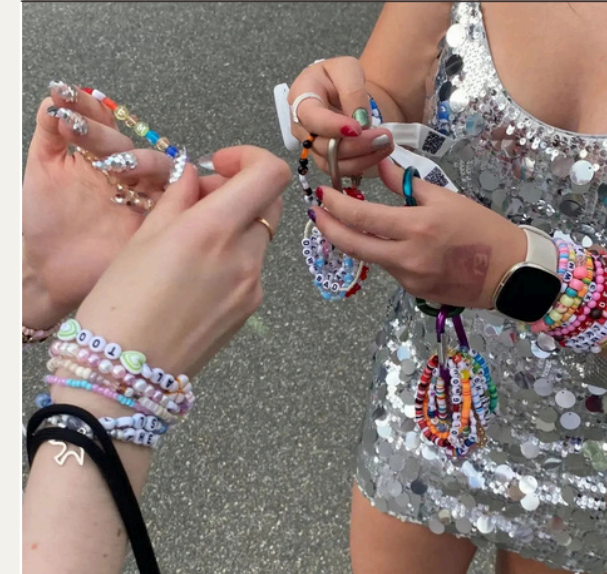
FASHION, BEAUTY & CONSUMER CULTURE



Scents of Resistance: When Gen Z Turned Perfume Into Identity



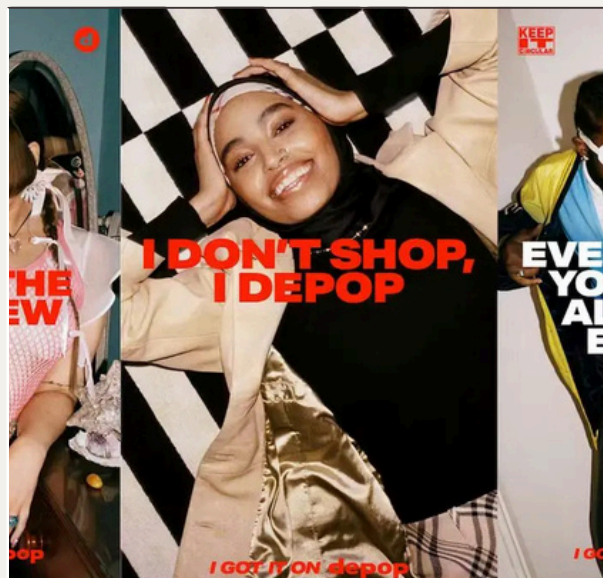
Beyond Glass Skin: Why K-Beauty Is Becoming A Pilgrimage



Fandom Dressing: How Stan Culture Is Reshaping Style



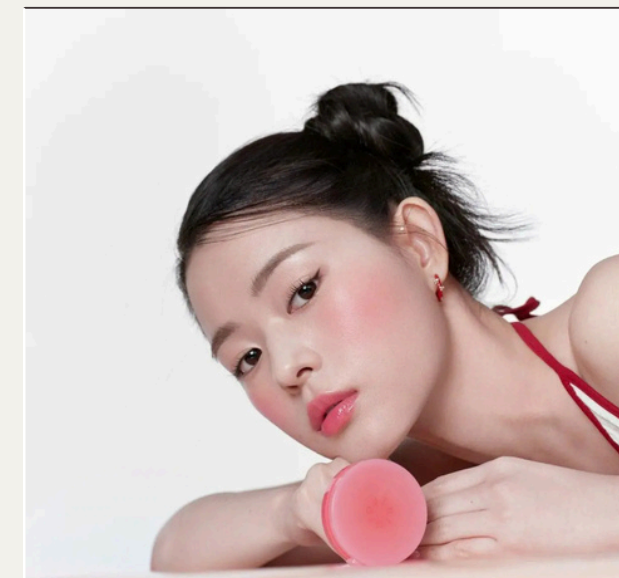
The Cult Of Athleisure: How Activewear Became The New Luxury



Secondhand Status: How Depop and Vinted Redefined Cool

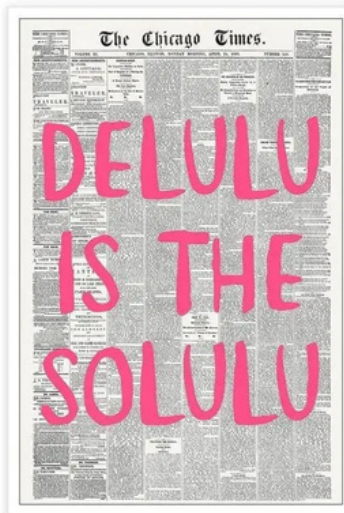


Quiet Disruptors: The New Names Reshaping NYFW



Blush As Narration: How K-Dramas Rewired Beauty

CULTURE, IDENTITY & DIGITAL BEHAVIOUR



Delulu as Power: Escapism, Identity, and Gen Z's Fantasy Obsession



The TV Shows That Built Us: How Screens Shape Generations



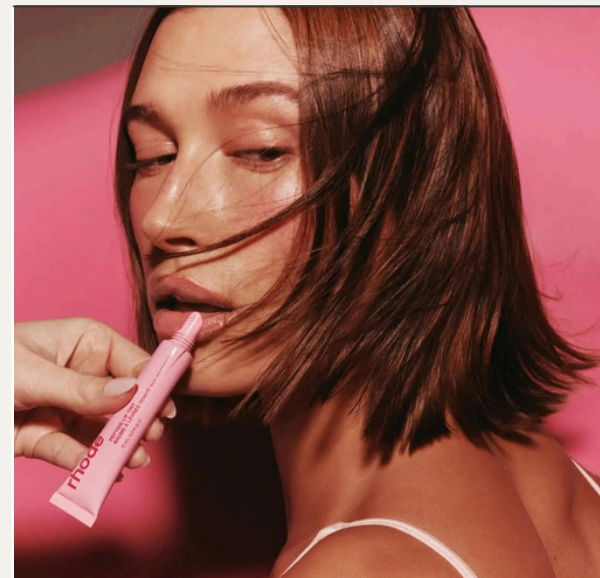
From New York to London: How Coquettecore Shaped Summer



Slutty, Sad, And Sparkly: The New Pop Star Formula



Why Founders Are Putting Identity Back at the Core of Their Brands



From Boss to Balm: The Soft-Power Rise of the Modern Founder



Reading Pinterest's 2026 Prediction

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INTERVIEWS & CREATIVE CONVERSATIONS



[Fragrance as Inheritance: Interview with Maya Njie](#)



[Inside the Sonic World of Blue Nude: Interview with Katarina Protsack](#)



[Zen Warrior: Alexandra Kafka On Burnout And Real Healing](#)



[Living In Between: Carson Allen On Identity And Craft](#)



[Talking People And The Art Of Unscripted Performance](#)

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CREATIVE DIRECTION & PHOTOGRAPHY



Editorial Social Concepts

Editorial picks highlighting emerging fashion, beauty, and culture voices, alongside creators and influencers shaping contemporary aesthetics and online conversations.

Instagram: [@leraytova](#)



Trend Forecasting & Visual Research

Trend-focused social content exploring current movements across fashion, beauty, internet culture, and digital aesthetics through curated visuals and cultural analysis.

LinkedIn: [Valerie Aitova](#)



Creative Direction

Moodboards, visual research, and creative direction developed for editorial shoots and fashion-focused projects.

email: leraytova@gmail.com

THANK YOU.

**Open to editorial, content and creative opportunities across
fashion, beauty and culture**

*Selected visuals include editorial references, published imagery, social
concepts, and visual research used for portfolio presentation purposes only.
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